

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 587

By Gardenhire

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Gregory Joe Ridley,
County Mayor of Bledsoe County, upon his
retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those public servants who, in their years of work, have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm; and

WHEREAS, Gregory Joe Ridley is one such estimable individual, who has served with distinction for twenty years as Mayor of Bledsoe County; in August of 2026, he will begin a well-deserved retirement; and

WHEREAS, Gregg Ridley has faithfully and honorably served as the County Mayor of Bledsoe County for twenty years, providing leadership, dedication, and vision to the citizens of this county; and

WHEREAS, born on April 9, 1962, to parents Marion Talley Ridley and Jo Hughes Ridley, he is one of six children; and

WHEREAS, on September 21, 1985, Gregory Joe Ridley married Janice Rebecca "Becky" Deakins; this loving couple has been blessed with two children, William Talley Ridley and Gregory Matthew Ridley, and four grandchildren within their forty-one years of marital happiness; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure as County Mayor, Gregg Ridley has demonstrated an unwavering commitment to fiscal responsibility, conservative values, community growth, and improving the quality of life for all residents; and

WHEREAS, under his leadership, Bledsoe County has achieved significant accomplishments, including working alongside the Bledsoe County Board of Commissioners and State and Federal officials to expand post-high school educational opportunities with the

October 2, 2024, groundbreaking for the construction of a 14,000-square foot Tennessee College of Applied Technology (TCAT) facility on US Highway 127 Bypass; enriching primary health care access for citizens with the completion of the \$1.56 million, 6,200-square-foot Erlanger-Bledsoe medical office building in 2022; constructing and then expanding a new local jail; expanding Bledsoe's potable water infrastructure for overall community well-being and high quality of life; and constructing a new health department; and

WHEREAS, Bledsoe County Mayor Gregg Ridley has built strong partnerships with local, state, and federal officials, as well as community organizations, always putting the needs of Bledsoe County first; and

WHEREAS, his leadership has been marked by integrity, humility, and a deep respect for the people he serves; and

WHEREAS, upon retirement, Gregg Ridley leaves a legacy of service, growth, and community pride that will continue to benefit generations of Bledsoe County citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor Mayor Gregory Joe Ridley upon the occasion of his retirement and commend his many years of distinguished service, wishing him continued success in all his future endeavors and a happy and fulfilling retirement.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.